



The Jamaica Constabulary Force

Standard Operating Procedures for Responding to Reports of Bomb Threat

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1.0 Introduction

Given the potential influence of global crime trends and the evolving criminal landscape due to organized crimes, the ability of law enforcement entities to respond effectively to major incidents such as bomb threats and other public emergencies is critical in safeguarding life and property. Due to the high level of risk associated with bomb threats to include; loss of life, injuries, damage to property, significant economic and psychological impact, a proactive approach must be strategically taken and incorporated into law enforcement operational response and investigative processes.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) must therefore posture itself to provide the requisite law enforcement response and support the National Emergency Response Plan in the event of any such public safety or national security threat.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this SOP is to outline the actions to be taken when a bomb threat is brought to the attention of the police and to ensure that the situation is brought under control in a timely manner.

3.0 Scope

This Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the JCF. It covers the management and investigative guidelines for all reports of bomb threats.

4.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
CCN	Constabulary Communication Network
C-TOC	Counter Terrorism and Organized Crime Investigation Branch
DCP	Deputy Commissioner of Police
DDO	Divisional Duty Officer
DIM	Divisional Intelligence Manager
DIU	Divisional Intelligence Unit
DNA	Deoxyribonucleic Acid
EOC	Emergency Operational Centre
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
MDT	Mobile Data Terminals
NIB	National Intelligence Bureau
PECC	Police Emergency Communication Centre

5.0 Definition

5.1 Bomb

A container filled with explosive, incendiary material, smoke, gas, or other destructive substance, designed to explode on impact or when detonated by a time mechanism, remote-control device, or lit fuse.

5.2 Bomb Threat

Any form of communication that indicates the presence of, or intent to detonate, cause death, injuries, damage to property, and/or incite fear or public disturbance whether or not such a device actually exists.

5.3 Bomb Disposal

A process by which hazardous explosive devices are disabled or otherwise rendered safe.

5.4 Hoax

A plan to deceive or a malicious report that a bomb has been planted when in fact it has not.

5.5 Threat Assessment Levels

There are two (2) levels of response when a bomb threat is received. The levels are as follows:

- a. **Threat Level 1** - where an assessment was conducted, and it is established that the report is a hoax and there is no need for the bomb disposal experts to be called to the scene.

- b. **Threat Level 2** – This level is initiated when a device is located on a scene. At this level the relevant agencies and departments shall be called out and the Jamaica Constabulary Force’s Emergency Operational Centre (EOC) activated.

5.6 Threat Assessment Report

This is a formal report that provides detailed findings from an assessment that was conducted to determine but is not limited to the risks and authenticity of a reported case of bomb threat.

5.7 Scene

For the purpose of this SOPs a scene shall be defined as any location where an explosive device is suspected or confirmed to be present.

6.0 Responsibilities

The following summarizes key roles and responsibilities:

6.1 Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) in-charge of Strategic Operations Portfolio shall:

- 6.1.1 provide strategic oversight and policy direction on all reported cases of bomb threats; and
- 6.1.2 declare a scene of bomb threat closed, on the advice of the expert.

6.2 Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Counter Terrorism and Organized Crime Investigation Branch (C-TOC) shall:

- 6.2.1 ensure that all reports of bomb threats are investigated in accordance with this SOP;
- 6.2.2 coordinate with relevant stakeholders to assist with investigations such as; forensic, Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA), ballistics and biometrics;
- 6.2.3 ensure that investigative standards for their operations are complied with; and
- 6.2.4 submit a comprehensive report to DCP Crime and Security Portfolio and copy to DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio on completion of the investigation.

6.3 Area Commander

Where a case of bomb threat has been reported, the Area Commander shall:

- 6.3.1 submit a preliminary report to DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio **within forty-eight (48) hours** of the report, whether the report was established to be a hoax or otherwise; and
- 6.3.2 provide oversight of the EOC, when required.

6.4 Divisional Commander/Divisional Duty Officer (DDO)

The Divisional Commander/DDO shall assume the following responsibilities:

- 6.4.1 ensure the appropriate resources are assigned to effectively manage traffic and crowd control;
- 6.4.2 establish the EOC and take command;
- 6.4.3 provide and manage resources where necessary to aid in investigations;
- 6.4.4 ensure that adequate personnel are deployed as first responders on the scene where a case of bomb threat has been reported;
- 6.4.5 ensure all reports of bomb threat that have been reported within their formation are communicated to Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC) immediately;
- 6.4.6 submit a preliminary report to Area Commander **within twenty-four (24) hours** of the report, whether a bomb is located or not;
- 6.4.7 implement safety protocols such as maintaining a safe distance from the suspected device and avoiding unnecessary risk; and
- 6.4.8 oversee the post incident management, ensuring the reopening of the area and the transition to normal operations.

- 6.5 Senior Superintendent of Police, in-charge Police Emergency Control Centre shall:**
- 6.5.1 assume the responsibility of the lead coordinator in operational management and provide the necessary communications and updates to the relevant authorities and stakeholders throughout the process;
 - 6.5.2 inform the Divisional Commander/DDO of all reports of bomb threat received, that affects their division;
 - 6.5.3 deploy the local patrol within the area to assume first response responsibilities which entails traffic management and crowd control;
 - 6.5.4 inform the Divisional Intelligence Manager (DIM) of the reported case of bomb threat for their appropriate action; and
 - 6.5.5 inform the relevant state emergency response entities where the situation necessitates their response.
- 6.6 Senior Superintendent of Police in-charge, National Intelligence Bureau (NIB) shall:**
- 6.6.1 coordinate the actions of the DIM and conduct intelligence checks (to include background checks of suspect if known); and
 - 6.6.2 provide intelligence support to the relevant stakeholders.
- 6.7 Senior Superintendent of Police in-charge, Constabulary Communication Network (CCN)** shall be responsible for the dissemination of information or press release(s) to the public.
- 6.8 Senior Superintendent of Police in-charge, Technical Services Division (Scenes of Crime)** shall be responsible for processing the scene in accordance with the JCF Policy and SOPs for the Management of Major Crime Scenes.
- 6.9 Superintendent of Police in-charge, Canine Division** shall deploy the necessary resources to assist in the search process, where practicable.

7.0 Roles and Functions

- 7.1.1 Divisional Intelligence Manager (DIM)**
- a. The DIM shall cause the scene to be searched by personnel from the Divisional Intelligence Unit (DIU) and conduct intelligence gathering which will aid in investigations.
 - b. Inform PECC of the findings which will assist with the threat assessment and the level of response.
 - c. Conduct a comprehensive search of the scene to ascertain adequate information.
- 7.1.2 Station Supervisor/Manager** shall immediately inform PECC and the Divisional Commander/DDO upon receipt of a report of bomb threat.

7.1.3 **First Responder (the local patrol within the area of concern)**

In conjunction with this SOP, the initial on-scene actions of the responding officer to the scene of a bomb threat shall be in keeping with the JCF Policy and SOPs on the Management of Major Crime Scenes and JCF Patrol and Emergency Response Policy and SOPs. These actions shall include:

- a. conduct an assessment of the area or premises;
- b. ensure public safety by establishing inner and outer cordon(s) where necessary and restricting access to the scene;
- c. speak to the relevant authority and/or witnesses on the ground in order to ascertain an update and gain further information;
- d. where necessary; isolate and/or evacuate the affected areas and locate, identify and assist in the removal of persons;
- e. update and hand over the scene to the first senior JCF member who arrives;
- f. initiate traffic control duties and provide safe access routes for members of the public and emergency services;
- g. provide an update to Divisional Commander/DDO and PECC; and
- h. await further instructions from Divisional Commander/DDO and PECC.

NB. First Responders should not attempt to search for or locate any explosive device (bomb)

8.0 **Standard Operating Procedures**

The following outlines the procedures for the management of reports of bomb threat:

8.1 **Appreciating Reports of Bomb Threat**

Upon receipt of report or information relative to a bomb threat, the following procedures apply:

- 8.1.1 All reports of bomb threat **MUST** be treated as Priority One emergency.
- 8.1.2 The Divisional Commander/DDO/Station Officer and PECC shall be informed without delay.
- 8.1.3 PECC should immediately inform DIM and dispatch the local patrol, which will assume the role of the first responder.
- 8.1.4 All evidence to include written documents must be properly secured and handed over to the investigating officer for safekeeping.
- 8.1.5 The receiving officer shall, where practicable, complete the *JCF Bomb Threat Checklist (Appendix)* to ascertain relevant information which will assist in the investigation.

8.2 **Levels of Response to a Bomb Threat**

On receiving a report of a bomb threat PECC shall activate the relevant response as follows:

8.2.1 **Level 1 Response**

- a. Deploy the local patrol to the scene to conduct preliminary investigation and update PECC.
- b. DIM must be informed of the report received and personnel from the DIU shall be deployed to the scene to conduct search and intelligence gathering, thereafter provide PECC with a threat assessment report.
- c. Where a suspicious device is detected, DIU must communicate this to PECC immediately.
- d. Where it is established that the reported case is that of a hoax, PECC shall inform C-TOC who shall conduct an investigation into the report.

8.2.2 Level 2 Response

Where a suspicious device is detected PECC shall immediately inform DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio of the discovery. DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio will instruct SSP PECC to inform the National Emergency Response Team/agencies.

NB. In all cases where there is a bomb threat whether hoax or a suspicious device is detected/planted, C-TOC must conduct investigations into the matter.

8.3 Emergency On-scene Response

- 8.3.1 In conjunction with this SOP, the initial on-scene actions of the responding officer shall be in keeping with the JCF SOPs on the Management of Major Crime Scenes and JCF Patrol and Emergency Response Policy and SOPs. These actions shall include:
- ensuring public safety by cordoning and restricting access to the area/section.
 - where necessary; isolate and/or evacuate the areas and locate, identify and assist in the removal of person(s);
 - initiating traffic control duties and provide safe access routes for members of the public and emergency services;
 - assist to secure and safeguard life and property;
 - preserve the scene where necessary until the relevant JCF and/or the national emergency response agencies arrive;
 - identify and interview witnesses to ascertain any update to the report that was received such as hostages being held or casualties;
 - enquire if any suspicious object(s) were seen or discovered on the scene and where specifically; and
 - provide periodical updates to PECC.

8.4 Explosive Device Pre-cautionary Measures

If an explosive device is located, the following actions shall be applied until the experts arrive:

- 8.4.1 Radio transmissions should be eliminated or limited as best as possible. Some explosive devices may be detonated by the electrical energy generated by radio transmissions, including Mobile Data Terminals (MDTs).
- 8.4.2 Portable radios should be utilized to communicate between PECC and command personnel and units on the scene within a perimeter that is considered safe.
- 8.4.3 No member of the JCF shall attempt to remove or disturb any suspicious device however; the member shall make a general observation, take notes and inform the relevant authority.
- 8.4.4 Buildings or premises should be evacuated immediately and persons moved to a safe location which has been declared safe.
- 8.4.5 In order to preserve the scene a perimeter (outer cordon) should be established to prevent persons from entering.

8.5 Activation of a Jamaica Constabulary Force Emergency Operational Centre

A Jamaica Constabulary Force EOC shall be established at the divisional level where the bomb disposal operation will be conducted.

8.6 Investigation of the scene when a case of bomb threat has been received and/or an explosive device defused/exploded

The Counter Terrorism and Organized Crime Investigation Branch (C-TOC) shall conduct comprehensive investigation of all bomb threats, where an explosive device has been found. The investigation should include the following:

- 8.6.1 Interview the complainant or victim who received the threat.
- 8.6.2 Ascertain the details of the method of the threat.
- 8.6.3 Engage Forensics and Cybercrimes Division (CFCD) for digital and forensic analysis where applicable.
- 8.6.4 Engage the JCF Scenes of Crime Unit who shall process the scene and where exhibit(s) such as explosive devices whether detonated, defused or related material was detected, this shall be handed over to the C-TOC investigator for evidential purposes
- 8.6.5 Conduct investigations in accordance with C-TOC's Standard Operating Procedures and this SOP.
- 8.6.6 Provide an initial update to DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio.
- 8.6.7 Collaborate with relevant stakeholders and agencies that were operational on the scene in order to obtain statements and reports.
- 8.6.8 Submit a comprehensive report to DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio and DCP Crime and Security Portfolio on completion of the investigation.
- 8.6.9 Assistant Commissioner of Police, C-TOC in consultation with DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio, may declare an investigation closed when all leads have been exhausted and/or a suspect has been held.

8.7 Bomb Threat involving Hostage

Notwithstanding procedures outlined in this SOP, all cases of bomb threat involving person(s) being held hostage, shall be strictly managed in accordance with the *JCF procedure in responding to hostage situation*.

8.8 Closure of Operation of the Scene of a Bomb Threat

A scene shall be declared closed by the DCP Strategic Operations Portfolio.

8.9 Relevant Form

Bomb Threat Report Checklist

8.10 Legislative/Guiding Principles

JCF Patrol and Emergency Response Policy and SOPs
JCF Case Management Policy and SOPs
JCF Procedure in Responding to Hostage Situation
JCF Policy and SOPs on the Management of Major Crime Scene



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Bomb Threat Report Checklist

Date of Report: ____/____/____ yyyy/mm/dd	Time of Report: ____: ____ am/pm
Division/Station/Formation receiving report: _____	
Officer receiving report: (Name, rank & Number): _____	
INFORMATION OF CALLER	
Name: _____	
Address/Location of Caller: _____	
Telephone Number: _____	
How did the call become aware of the Bomb Threat? _____	
INFORMATION OF THE PERPETRATOR (IF KNOWN)	
Name: _____	
Address/Location: _____	
Brief Description of the perpetrator (age, sex, mental state, ethnicity, religious affiliation, etc.): _____ _____ _____ _____	
ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS	
1. When is the bomb expected to explode? _____	
2. Where is the bomb located? _____	
3. What does the Bomb look like? _____	
4. Can you say what kind of bomb it is? _____	
5. Do you know who planted the bomb? _____ _____	
6. If yes to Question 5, who and/or Why? _____	
7. Is anyone being held hostage? _____	
CALLER VOICE ASSESSMENT	
Description of Caller's Voice (Tick all that applies)	
Calm ☐ Slow ☐ Crying ☐ Slurred/Intoxicated ☐ Angry ☐ Stutter ☐ Deep ☐ Laughter/Giggling ☐ Foreign Accent ☐	
Disguised/Computer –Aided ☐ Other ☐ _____	
If voice is familiar, who does it sound like? _____	
Describe any background noise _____	
Language Used - Well Spoken ☐ Indecent/Foul ☐	
EXACT WORD OF THREAT/ANY OTHER INFORMATION	
Any other comment(s): _____	
